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Li Kevin Wenliang

Senior Research Scientist

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Finding general principles of intelligence underlying artificial and biological agents. In capability research, I work on generative models and density estimation, with applications to protein design, human behaviours, and time-series. On interpretability, the success factors and failure modes of the existing methodologies are elucidated from the first principles.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Google DeepMind Senior Research Scientist	2022–2026
• SOTA multi-modal (discrete and continuous) diffusion model with applications to protein design	London, UK
• Understanding and interpreting diffusion and sequence predictors from geometric, information and statistical principles	
• Methods and theories of distributional reinforcement learning, tested on robotic environments and Atari games	
University College London Honorary Fellow	2022–2024
• Mental physics simulation: designed experiments, analyzed behavioural and MEG data	London, UK
Amazon Web Services Research Scientist Intern	2020–2021
• Mentored by David Wipf on advancing variational autoencoder models	Remote
• Research on value of infinite gradients in VAE models, published at NeurIPS 2021	
Microsoft Research Research Intern	Jun–Oct 2014
• Computer vision research under Sebastian Nowozin	Cambridge, UK
• Developed methods for visual recognition and image analysis	
Swiftkey Ltd Engineer Intern	Jun–Sep 2011
• Natural language processing research for predictive text systems	London, UK
• Initiated core algorithms development for mobile keyboard input methods	

EDUCATION

Gatsby Computational Neuroscience Unit, University College London	2015–2021
<i>Ph.D. in Machine Learning and Theoretical Neuroscience</i>	
Advisors: Prof Maneesh Sahani and Prof Peter Dayan	
Thesis: Nonparametric Enrichment in Computational and Biological Representation of Distributions	
Visiting positions: Prof Zoe Kourtzi, visual perceptual learning; Prof Liping Wang, sequence perception and learning	
University of Cambridge, Trinity College	2010–2014
<i>M.Eng. (Distinction) and B.A. (Class I) in Information and Computer Engineering.</i>	
Advisor: Prof Máté Lengyel. Thesis: Learning state-space models for neuronal spike prediction.	
• Trinity College Senior Scholar • Top 10 among 300	
Massachusetts Institute of Technology	2012–2013
<i>Exchange, Electrical Engineering and Computer Science. GPA: 4.9/5.0</i>	

ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

Co-Organizer ICML Workshop on AI4Science	Jun 2024
Teaching Assistant Computational and Cognitive Neuroscience Summer School, Suzhou	Jul 2023
Project Mentor NeuroMatch Academy Summer School, online	Jul 2021
Teaching Assistant NeuroMatch Academy Summer School, online	Jul 2020
Teaching Assistant Machine Learning Summer School, London	Jul 2019
Teaching Assistant Gatsby Unit courses, London	2016–2017

INVITED TALKS

Oxford University, Algorithmic Information Theory Symposium	July 2026
University of Texas at Austin, RL reading group	Apr 2024
Max-Planck Institute for Biological Cybernetics	Mar 2024
AAAI Workshop: Explainable machine learning for sciences	Mar 2023
Beijing Normal University	Mar 2021
Chinese Institute for Brain Research	Jan 2021
Chinese Academy of Sciences, Institute of Neuroscience	Dec 2020
Cambridge Neurocomputation and AI in Neuroscience	Mar 2020

SKILLS

Programming	Python (JAX/Flax/Haiku, PyTorch, TensorFlow, Caffe), Julia, MATLAB, HTML/CSS/JS
Research Focus	Diffusion generative models, approximate inference, density estimation, time-series
Languages	English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (native)